not tied to any nation-state. Such a move would help save the global economy from the dangers of continued reliance on the US dollar, an atavistic residue from an earlier era of US dominance in a world system of national capitalisms and hegemonic nation-states.

There is nothing in BRICS politics and proposals that have stood in any significant contradiction to global capitalism. On the contrary, by and large the BRICS platform pushes further integration into global capitalism. Brazilian and Southern opposition to the subsidy regime for agriculture in the North constituted opposition not to capitalist globalisation but precisely to a policy that stood in the way of such globalisation. BRICS politics sought to open up further the global system for elites in their respective countries. Some of these efforts do clash with the G7, but BRICS proposals would have the effect of extending and contributing to the stabilisation of global capitalism and, in the process, of further transnationalising the dominant groups in these countries. This is not a case of the old anti-colonialism and cannot be explained in the context of earlier First World–Third World contradictions that do not capture the current dynamics. Prashad misreads the economic and political protagonism of BRICS elites. Far from indicating a polarised confrontation or antagonistic interests, this protagonism has for the most part been aimed at constructing a more expansive and balanced global capitalism.

Let us look at this matter further. Brazil led the charge against Northern agricultural subsidies in several international forums in the first decade of the 21st century. Its argument was that such subsidies unfairly undermined the competitiveness of Brazilian agricultural exports. Brazil was seeking more, not less, globalisation: a global free market in agricultural commodities. Who in Brazil would benefit from the lifting of Northern agricultural subsidies? Above all, it would benefit the soy barons and other giant agro-industrial exporters that dominate Brazilian agriculture. And who are these barons and exporters? A study of the Brazilian economy reveals that they are agribusiness interests in Brazil that bring together Brazilian capitalists and land barons with the giant TNCs that drive global agribusiness and that themselves, in their ownership and cross-investment structures, bring together individual and institutional investors from around the world, such as Monsanto, ADM, Cargill, and so forth. Simply put, 'Brazilian' agricultural exports are transnational capital agricultural exports. Adopting a nation-state-centric framework of analysis makes this look like a Brazilian national conflict with powerful Northern countries.

If Brazil got its way it would not have curtailed but have furthered capitalist globalisation and would have advanced the interests of transnational capital.